

THE ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE FOUNDATION

The Architecture of *Grace*

Preview the Architecture

A guided sample of one idea — the question “Who Am I?” — shown as it grows with the child from kindergarten through twelfth grade. One construct. Five developmental rungs. The whole method in miniature.

IDENTITY · SELF-COMPASSION · FORGIVENESS · GRACE

THE IDENTITY THREAD, ACROSS THE GRADE BANDS

One Question, Five Rungs

“Who am I — and can I hold that honestly?”

↑ THE SAME QUESTION, ASKED FIVE WAYS ↑

11–12

BOOK 5 · CAPSTONE

The Threshold

BOOK 5 · UNIT 1 · LESSON 1

Leaving and arriving — what you carry across the threshold into adulthood, and what you choose to leave behind.

SAMPLE INCLUDED

9–10

BOOK 4 · FAÇADE

The Curated Self

BOOK 4 · UNIT 1 · LESSON 1

The gap between the curated self and the authentic self — and the Performance Tax of holding it.

SAMPLE INCLUDED

6–8

BOOK 3 · INTERIOR

The Mask vs. the Mirror

BOOK 3 · UNIT 1 · LESSON 1

The persona we perform, and the self underneath — the cost lives in the gap between them.

SAMPLE INCLUDED

3–5

BOOK 2 · FRAMEWORK

The Identity Web

BOOK 2 · UNIT 1 · LESSON 1

The web returns, now with language for strengths, values, and the parts others don't see.

SAMPLE INCLUDED

K–2

BOOK 1 · FOUNDATION

The Identity Web

BOOK 1 · UNIT 1 · LESSON 1

Children map the pieces of who they are — every web valid, every answer right.

SAMPLE INCLUDED

The Identity Web

Who I Am — All the Pieces of Me • grades K–2

THE QUESTION

“Who am I?”

The year opens here. Children map the pieces of who they are onto a web — and learn, before anything harder, that every web is valid and every answer is right.

THE ANCHOR CHART

MY IDENTITY WEB • THE BRANCHES

- Things I LOVE — my favorite people and things to do
- Things I’m GOOD AT — what I can do
- Things I CARE ABOUT — people, animals, or ideas that matter to me
- My SPECIAL Thing — something just about me
- Things I’m STILL LEARNING — what I want to get better at

Teacher note: post the web before distributing it; build one branch at a time. Keep it posted all year — the relational anchor the whole year returns to.

The Identity Web, Deepened

Strengths, values, and the parts unseen • grades 3–5

THE QUESTION

“Who am I — and can I hold that honestly, without shame and without pretending?”

The same web returns, now with language for strengths and values — and the first honest look at the parts of ourselves other people don’t see.

THE ANCHOR CHART

IDENTITY WEB • FIVE BRANCHES (DISPLAY MODEL)

- Things I Love
- Things I’m Good At
- Things that Matter to Me
- Things People Don’t Know
- Things I’m Still Figuring Out

Scenario Card 1-A • Who Am I? Marcus shared that he loves drawing comics. A classmate said, “That’s babyish.” Is Marcus’s love of comics part of who he truly is — and what

The Mask vs. the Mirror

The performance, and what is real underneath · grades 6–8

THE QUESTION

“What do I show others — and what is actually there when the performance stops?”

Adolescence makes identity a performance. This lesson names the gap between the Mask we project and the Mirror underneath — not to shame the Mask, but to see what it costs.

THE ANCHOR CHART

THE MASK — WHAT I SHOW

- What I perform for others
- What I hide
- What I emphasize
- The version I want seen

THE MIRROR — WHAT IS REAL

- My real opinions
- My actual struggles
- What I value
- What’s there when performance stops

“The gap between these two is where the cost lives.” Students complete an Identity Audit — naming, privately, two places their Mask and Mirror have drifted apart.

The Curated Self

The curated self, and the Performance Tax · grades 9–10

THE QUESTION

“The question is not whether you have a gap between your curated and authentic self — it is what it is costing you.”

The Mask grows up and goes online. Here the gap gets a name and a price — the Performance Tax — and students begin, privately, to measure their own.

THE ANCHOR CHART

THE CURATED SELF

- Filtered · selected
- Performed for an audience
- What you show
- Costly to maintain

THE AUTHENTIC SELF

- Unfiltered · private
- Costly to reveal
- What is actually true
- The self underneath the feed

On the board: $PERFORMANCE\ TAX = GAP \times TIME$. The wider the gap and the longer it is held, the more it consumes — the same working memory needed for everything else that matters.

The Threshold

Leaving and arriving • grades 11–12

THE QUESTION

“Of everything you have been and built — what do you carry through the threshold, and what do you leave behind?”

The final year. Students conduct an exit interview with themselves — honest, not the college-essay version — and decide who arrives on the other side of the threshold.

THE ANCHOR CHART

WHAT YOU ARE LEAVING

- The context that built you
- The people who know your history
- The roles that defined you
- The version made for this place

WHAT YOU ARE ARRIVING INTO

- A place that doesn't know your past
- People with no prior story of you
- A self you choose from scratch
- Who shows up — by choice

The continuity question: what travels through the threshold with you — and what holds it in place when the context that kept it visible is gone?

THE THREAD CONTINUES

Five years, one question

This is the identity thread alone — one of several that run the length of the program, beside self-compassion, forgiveness, and grace. Each lives in full lessons with anchor charts, worksheets, scenario cards, and a companion novel for every band.

FOR SCHOOLS & DISTRICTS

License the program

Bring the whole K–12 ecosystem to your school or district. We'll send a quote and help you set it up.

FOR FAMILIES

Visit the family store

Buy books, packs, and home editions for the kitchen table. Free previews are always open.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE

A check-up, not an exam.